

May 23, 2026

Editor-in-Chief
Computer Physics Communications

Dear Editor,

We submit a revised version of our manuscript, “`dec_stem_for_computer`: A Python package for TV-regularized Richardson-Lucy deconvolution of HAADF-STEM images.” We thank you and the five reviewers for the thorough and constructive evaluation, which has substantially improved the paper. All high-priority and medium-priority issues have been addressed as detailed in the accompanying Response to Reviewers.

Summary of major revisions:

- **Computational physics framing.** The Introduction has been substantially rewritten to foreground the computational inverse problem for CPC readership (EIC concern).
- **Numerical methods.** A Chambolle projection algorithm now implements the FISTA-TV proximal operator. Biggs-Andrews vector extrapolation with proper data-dependent step sizing replaces the previous simple momentum scheme. FFT zero-padding to power-of-two is now the default behavior.
- **Metrics module.** A new `metrics.py` module provides SNR, SSIM, MSE, and FRC computation for quantitative evaluation against ground truth.
- **Curvature analysis.** Section 4.5 has been rewritten as a consistency characterization with explicit acknowledgment of circularity and a three-parameter comparison.
- **Quantitative rigor.** Table 1 now reports mean $\pm$ SD over $N = 5$ independent noise realizations. A standard Wiener deconvolution baseline has been added.
- **Software documentation.** Section 3.1 has been expanded to describe the layered architecture, strategy pattern, data flow, and FFT padding. Module names now accurately reflect the actual code structure.

All reviewer comments have been addressed point-by-point. We believe the revised manuscript meets CPC standards and is suitable for publication. The software is open-source (MIT) at https://github.com/chenguisen/dec_stem_for_computer, with installation instructions, test data, and documentation.

Sincerely,

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(on behalf of all authors)